OSCOLA Test Document

Testing OSCOLA 4 (existing) and OSCOLA 5 (new) features

23rd March 2026

This document tests both the existing entry-types from OSCOLA 4 and the new features added for OSCOLA 5 compliance. Each section shows the expected output above the package's actual output.

1 Existing features (regression tests)

1.1 Books

* Andrew Burrows, *Remedies for Torts and Breach of Contract* (3rd edn, OUP 2004) 317.

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* Justine Pila, 'The Value of Authorship in the Digital Environment' in William H Dutton and Paul W Jeffreys (eds), *World Wide Research: Reshaping the Sciences and Humanities in the Century of Information* (MIT Press 2010).

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* John Cartwright, 'The Fiction of the "Reasonable Man"' in AG Castermans and others (eds), *Ex Libris Hans Nieuwenhuis* (Kluwer 2009).

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[NB The above uses `crossref` in the `.bib` file.]

1.2 Cases

* *Boulton v Jones* (1857) 2 H&N 564, 157 ER 232.

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* *Henly v Mayor of Lyme* (1828) 5 Bing 91, 107; 130 ER 995, 1001.

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2 OSCOLA 5 changes

2.1 Ibid abolished by default (OSCOLA 5 s 1.2.3)

Repeated citations of the same source should produce the short-form cross-citation, not *ibid*. The second footnote below must *not* read ‘ibid’.

Expected: [n] Burrows (n [prev]) 100.

Package:[1][2].

To restore OSCOLA 4 ibid behaviour, pass `ibid=true` as a package option.

2.2 Thesis titles italicised (OSCOLA 5 s 3.7.6)

Expected: Javan Herberg, *Injunctive Relief for Wrongful Termination of Employment* (DPhil thesis, University of Oxford 1989).

Package: Javan Herberg, *Injunctive Relief for Wrongful Termination of Employment* (DPhil thesis, University of Oxford 1989).

[1] Andrew Burrows, *Remedies for Torts and Breach of Contract* (3rd edn, OUP 2004) 317.

[2] Burrows (n 1) 100.

2.3 Newspaper articles no city (OSCOLA 5 s 3.7.7)

Expected: Jane Croft, 'Supreme Court Warns on Quality' *Financial Times* (1 July 2010) 3.

(The city 'London' must *not* appear.)

Package: Jane Croft, 'Supreme Court Warns on Quality' *Financial Times* (1 July 2010) 3.

2.4 ECLI as default for EU cases (OSCOLA 5 s 4.4.2)

Expected: Joined Cases C-430/93 and C-431/93 *Jereon van Schijndel v Stichting Pensioenfonds voor Fysiotherapeuten* EU:C:1995:441.

(The ECR citation must *not* appear when an ECLI is available.)

Package: Joined Cases C-430/93 and C-431/93 *Jereon van Schijndel v Stichting Pensioenfonds voor Fysiotherapeuten* EU:C:1995:441.

2.5 Podcasts (OSCOLA 5 s 3.7.2)

Expected: Joe Bloggs, 'Making Up the Law' (*The Fictitious Law Pod*, 1 April 2023) 27:14–35:22 ⟨https://perma.cc/FAKE-PCST⟩.

(No 'accessed' date: Perma.cc URL. Timestamp appears after the date parens.)

Package: Joe Bloggs, 'Making Up the Law' (*The Fictitious Law Pod*, 1 April 2023) 27:14–35:22 ⟨https://perma.cc/FAKE-PCST⟩.

2.6 Social media posts (OSCOLA 5 s 3.7.1)

Expected: @The Criminal Bar (*Twitter*, 26 June 2023, 9:13pm GMT+1) ⟨https://perma.cc/HD6K-3GZQ⟩.

(No 'accessed' date: Perma.cc URL.)

Package: @The Criminal Bar (*Twitter*, 26 June 2023, 9:13pm GMT+1) ⟨https://perma.cc/HD6K-3GZQ⟩.

2.7 Book reviews (OSCOLA 5 s 3.5)

Expected: AG Guest, 'An Introduction to the Law of Contract' (1961) 24 MLR 658 (book review).

Package: A G Guest, 'An Introduction to the Law of Contract' (1961) 24 MLR 658 (book review).

Expected: Donal Nolan, 'Enterprise Liability and the Common Law' (2012) 41 ILJ 370 (book review).

Package: Donal Nolan, 'Enterprise Liability and the Common Law' (2012) 41 ILJ 370 (book review).

2.8 Timestamp pinpoints (OSCOLA 5 s 3.1.3)

The timestamp postnote must appear after the date parenthesis and before the URL (not at the end of the citation).

Expected: UK Supreme Court, 'Lady Hale's Valedictory Remarks – 18 December 2019' (*YouTube*, 18 December 2019) 42:41–51:17 ⟨https://perma.cc/7YZV-Y43A⟩.

Package: UK Supreme Court, 'Lady Hale's Valedictory Remarks – 18 December 2019' (*YouTube*, 18 December 2019) 42:41–51:17 ⟨https://perma.cc/7YZV-Y43A⟩.

2.9 Perma.cc URLs no 'accessed' date (OSCOLA 5 s 3.1.4)

A `urldate` field is present in the entry but must be *suppressed* because the URL begins with `perma.cc`.

Expected: Cyclefree, 'Is This Really Necessary, Minister?' (*Legal Feminist*, 27 April 2023) ⟨https://perma.cc/3THK-P4AX⟩.

(No 'accessed . . . ' text after the URL.)

Package: Cyclefree, 'Is This Really Necessary, Minister?' (*Legal Feminist*, 27 April 2023) ⟨https://perma.cc/3THK-P4AX⟩.

Compare with a non-Perma.cc URL where 'accessed' should still appear:

Expected: Sarah Cole, 'Virtual Friend Fires Employee' *Naked Law* (1 May 2009) ⟨...⟩ accessed 9 November 2009.

Package: Sarah Cole, 'Virtual Friend Fires Employee' (*Naked Law*, 1 May 2009) ⟨http://www.nakedlaw.com/2009/05/index.html⟩ accessed 9 November 2009.

2.10 Court rules CrPR and FPR (OSCOLA 5 s 2.5.3)

CrPR and FPR should be cited without SI number, and with the rule number following directly (no 'Order' prefix), just like CPR.

Expected: CrPR r 17.

Package: CrPR r 17.

Expected: FPR r 4.1.

Package: FPR r 4.1.

2.11 Assimilated EU law (OSCOLA 5 s 2.4.9)

Expected: Assimilated Regulation (EC) No 593/2008 ... [2008] OJ L177/6, as amended by SI 2019/834, reg 10.

Package: Assimilated Regulation (EC) No 593/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 17 June 2008 on the law applicable to contractual obligations [2008] OJ L177/6, as amended by SI 2019/834, reg 10.

2.12 Scottish Court of Session CSIH/CSOH implies the division (OSCOLA 5)

When the neutral citation already names the division (CSIH or CSOH), no separate IH/OH identifier should appear.

Expected: *Ponticelli Ltd v Gallagher* [2023] CSIH 32, 2023 SLT 823.

Package: *Ponticelli Ltd v Gallagher* [2023] CSIH 32, 2023 SLT 823.

When there is no neutral citation, the IH/OH designation must appear.

Expected: *Adams v Advocate General* 2003 SC 171 (OH), 175.

Package: *Adams v Advocate General* 2003 SC 171 (OH) 175.

2.13 No terminal full stop in bibliography (OSCOLA 5 s 1.7)

Check that entries in the bibliography below do *not* end with a full stop.

3 Other changes

3.1 EU legislation: no page number (new OJ format)

Newer editions of the OJ do not carry page numbers. The series letter (`L`, `C`, etc.) must appear without a trailing slash.

Expected: Regulation (EU) 2025/783 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 April 2025 amending Regulation (EU) 2018/196 on additional customs duties on imports of certain products originating in the United States of America [2025] OJ L.

Package: Regulation (EU) 2025/783 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 April 2025 amending Regulation (EU) 2018/196 on additional customs duties on imports of certain products originating in the United States of America [2025] OJ L.

3.2 Generative AI (OSCOLA 5 s 3.7.13)

AI outputs: author is the AI name, prompt in inverted commas after 'response to', then organisation and date in parens. No italics anywhere.

Expected: ChatGPT, response to 'Explain how artificial intelligence works', OpenAI (16 July 2023).

Package: ChatGPT, response to 'Explain how artificial intelligence works', OpenAI (16 July 2023).

Expected: ChatGPT, response to 'How to cite ChatGPT in the style of OSCOLA', OpenAI (16 July 2023).

Package: ChatGPT, response to 'How to cite ChatGPT in the style of OSCOLA', OpenAI (16 July 2023).

3.3 Welsh Parliament legislation asc/anaw/dccc numbers

Acts of the National Assembly for Wales (`anaw/dccc`) and Welsh Parliament (`asc`) should print the number in parentheses after the title and year.

Expected: Deddf Trawsblannu Dynol (Cymru) 2013 (dccc 5).

Package: Deddf Trawsblannu Dynol (Cymru) 2013 (dccc 5).

Expected: Child (Abolition of Defence of Reasonable Punishment) (Wales) Act 2020 (anaw 3).

Package: Child (Abolition of Defence of Reasonable Punishment) (Wales) Act 2020 (anaw 3).

Expected: Welsh Tax Acts etc (Power to Modify) Act 2022 (asc 2).

Package: Welsh Tax Acts etc (Power to Modify) Act 2022 (asc 2).

References

@The Criminal Bar (*Twitter*, 26 June 2023, 9:13pm GMT+1) ⟨https://perma.cc/HD6K-3GZQ⟩

Bloggs J, 'Making Up the Law' (*The Fictitious Law Pod*, 1 April 2023) ⟨https://perma.cc/FAKE-PCST⟩

Boulton v Jones (1857) 2 H&N 564, 157 ER 232

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ChatGPT, response to 'Explain how artificial intelligence works', OpenAI (16 July 2023)

— response to, 'How to cite ChatGPT in the style of OSCOLA', OpenAI (16 July 2023)

Child (Abolition of Defence of Reasonable Punishment) (Wales) Act 2020 (anaw 3)

Cole S, 'Virtual Friend Fires Employee' (*Naked Law*, 1 May 2009) ⟨http://www.nakedlaw.com/2009/05/index.html⟩ accessed 9 November 2009

CrPR

Croft J, 'Supreme Court Warns on Quality' *Financial Times* (1 July 2010) 3

Cyclefree, 'Is This Really Necessary, Minister?' (*Legal Feminist*, 27 April 2023) ⟨https://perma.cc/3THK-P4AX⟩

Deddf Trawsblannu Dynol (Cymru) 2013 (dccc 5)

Joined Cases C-430/93 and C-431/93 *Jereon van Schijndel v Stichting Pensioenfonds voor Fysiotherapeuten* EU:C:1995:441

FPR

Guest AG, 'An Introduction to the Law of Contract' (1961) 24 MLR 658 (book review)

Henly v Mayor of Lyme (1828) 5 Bing 91, 130 ER 995

Herberg J, *Injunctive Relief for Wrongful Termination of Employment* (DPhil thesis, University of Oxford 1989)

Nolan D, 'Enterprise Liability and the Common Law' (2012) 41 ILJ 370 (book review)

Adams v Advocate General 2003 SC 171 (OH)

Pila J, 'The Value of Authorship in the Digital Environment' in WH Dutton and PW Jeffreys (eds), *World Wide Research: Reshaping the Sciences and Humanities in the Century of Information* (MIT Press 2010)

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Regulation (EU) 2025/783 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 April 2025 amending Regulation (EU) 2018/196 on additional customs duties on imports of certain products originating in the United States of America [2025] OJ L

UK Supreme Court, 'Lady Hale's Valedictory Remarks – 18 December 2019' (*YouTube*, 18 December 2019) ⟨https://perma.cc/7YZV-Y43A⟩

Welsh Tax Acts etc (Power to Modify) Act 2022 (asc 2)